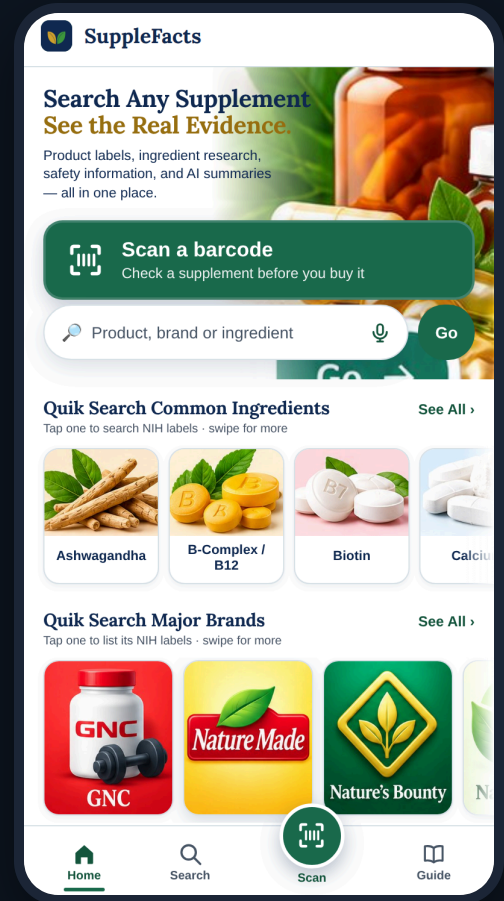


How to Use SuppleFacts

A phone guide to scanning or searching real supplement labels, getting an AI summary of every ingredient, and running a deeper evidence check with Claude, ChatGPT, or Perplexity.

CHECK THE EVIDENCE · MAKE INFORMED CHOICES



Quick Start

Five steps from a bottle on the shelf to a plain-language read on what is inside. Each step has a full page later in this guide.

1 Put SuppleFacts on your Home Screen (once)

Open supplements.brokenpromiseshealthcare.org/supplefacts.html in Safari (iPhone) or Chrome (Android), tap **Share** (or the three-dot menu), then **Add to Home Screen**.

2 Tap Scan, or search

Tap the round green **Scan** button in the middle of the bottom bar, allow the camera, and hold the barcode inside the white box about a hand-width away. No barcode? Type a name in Search, or tap the **microphone** in the search box and say it.

3 Check the match

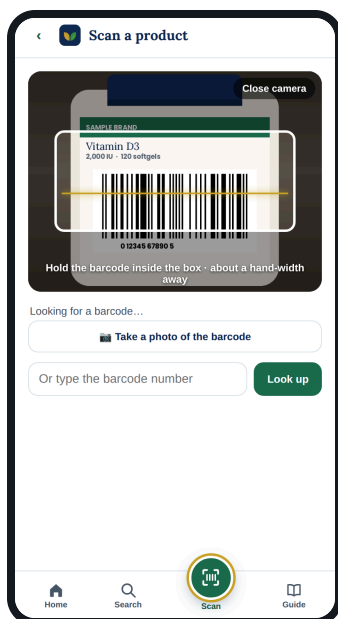
Matched by barcode means the barcode matches an NIH label. **Likely match** means NIH lists a product with this name; compare its ingredient list with the bottle in your hand.

4 Open the label and tap Generate summary

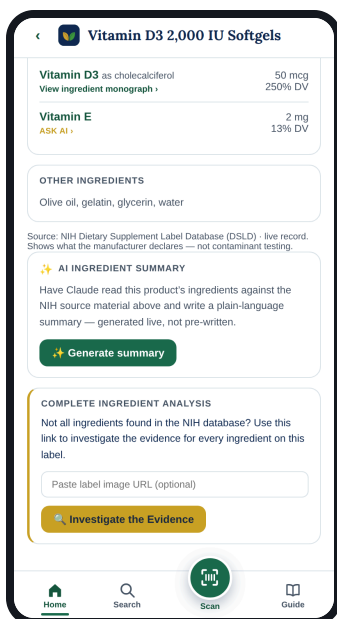
Tap **Show ingredients & evidence**, scroll to the AI Ingredient Summary, and tap the green button. The plain-language summary appears in a few seconds.

5 Investigate the evidence (optional)

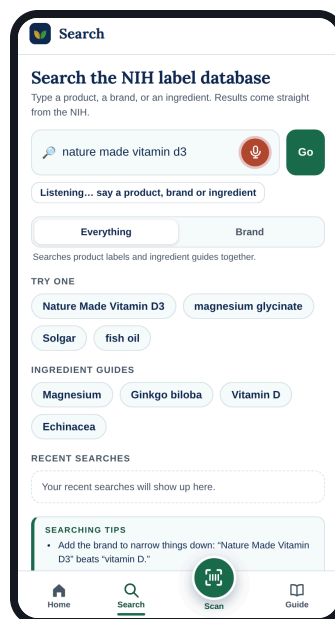
Tap the gold **Investigate the Evidence** button to send the whole label and a research prompt to Claude, ChatGPT, or Perplexity.



Scan: barcode in the white box



Label, summary button, evidence



Or search by voice

BARCODE WILL NOT SCAN?

Tap **Take a photo of the barcode**, or type the number printed under the bars and tap **Look up**. SuppleFacts is a research aid, not medical advice: check anything important with your pharmacist or doctor.

What This Guide Covers

SuppleFacts puts the NIH's database of real supplement labels in your pocket. Scan a barcode or search a product, see exactly what is on its label, then check the evidence behind every ingredient. This guide shows you how, one screen at a time, with plain steps for scanning, the two evidence buttons and for using the AI apps on your phone.

The app is independent. No sponsor pays for it, and nothing in it replaces a conversation with your own doctor or pharmacist. SuppleFacts is built to help you ask better questions of both.

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About SuppleFacts

SuppleFacts is the phone companion to The American Supplement Investigation, the website and three-book series by Robert Coleman, MS Pharm., and Joy Meier, Pharm.D. It puts the site's core idea, *check the evidence before you buy*, in your pocket.

What it does

- **Scans barcodes.** Point your phone camera at the barcode on a bottle and the app finds the matching NIH label, so you can check a product in the store aisle.
- **Searches real labels.** Type a search, or tap the microphone and say it. Every search runs live against the NIH Office of Dietary Supplements' Dietary Supplement Label Database (DSLD), which holds over 200,000 U.S. product labels as submitted by manufacturers.
- **Shows the label clearly.** Brand, product, serving size, every declared ingredient and its amount, other ingredients, and label claims.
- **Explains the ingredients.** Curated ingredient guides (monographs) in plain language or clinical detail, plus a live AI Ingredient Summary written by Claude for the exact product you open.
- **Goes deeper on request.** One tap sends the whole label and a research prompt to the AI of your choice, so you can check doses and compare studies.

Where the information comes from

SuppleFacts keeps no product database of its own. The NIH stays the source of truth for what is on a label, and the app's job is connecting that label to the evidence. The AI features are research helpers, not authorities.

Put it on your Home Screen

SuppleFacts is a web app, so there is nothing to download from an app store. Add it to your Home Screen once and it opens full screen like any other app. The address is **supplements.brokenpromiseshealthcare.org/supplefacts.html**.

IPHONE (SAFARI)

- Open the SuppleFacts address in Safari.
- Tap the **Share** button (square with an arrow).
- Scroll and tap **Add to Home Screen**, then **Add**. The SuppleFacts leaf icon (navy square, gold and green leaves) is now on your Home Screen.

ANDROID (CHROME)

- Open the same address in Chrome.
- Tap the **three-dot menu** at the top right.
- Tap **Install app** or **Add to Home screen**, then confirm.

TIP

The app shows a short reminder card with these steps the first time you open it on a phone; tap the X to dismiss it. If the app ever looks out of date after an update, close and reopen it. Removing the Home Screen icon and adding it again always fetches the latest version.

Scan a Barcode

Scanning turns the barcode on a bottle into its NIH label in a few seconds, so you can check a product while you stand in the aisle.

1 Tap Scan

Use the round green **Scan** button in the middle of the bottom bar, or the **Scan a barcode** button on the Home screen.

2 Allow the camera

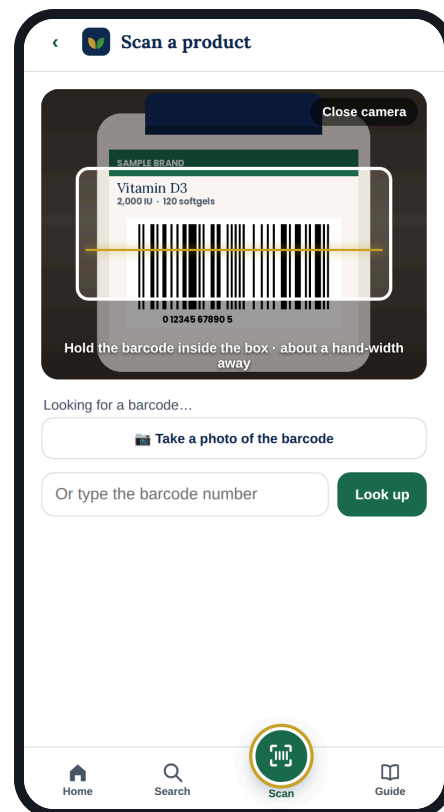
The first time, your phone asks permission to use the camera. Tap **Allow**. The picture stays on your phone and is never uploaded.

3 Hold the barcode inside the white box

Keep the bottle about a hand-width away, with the barcode flat and well lit. The app reads a number only when it sees the same one twice in a row, so hold steady for a second. If your phone supports it, a **Light** button turns on the flashlight.

4 See the result

The camera closes and a result card appears. The next page explains the three possible results.



The scan screen: barcode inside the white box.

IF IT WILL NOT READ

- **Tilt the bottle** to remove glare, especially on shiny or curved labels, and try the **Light** button in dim aisles.
- Tap **Take a photo of the barcode** and let the app read the photo instead.
- Type the digits printed under the bars into **Or type the barcode number**, then tap **Look up**.
- Or give up on the code and search by name; see Finding a Supplement.

QR CODES ARE IGNORED

Only the standard striped product barcode (UPC or EAN) is read. A QR code printed next to it, a very common sight on supplement bottles, will not confuse the scan.

WHAT LEAVES YOUR PHONE

Only the barcode number is sent, to look up the product. Your camera view and any photo you take stay on your phone.

What the Result Means

The barcode itself says nothing about ingredients. The app uses it to learn the product name from public product databases, then looks for that product in the NIH label database. You see one of three results.

MATCHED BY BARCODE

Sample Brand – Vitamin D3 2,000 IU Softgels

on market · entered NIH 2025-03-01

The barcode matches this NIH label.

Show ingredients & evidence ›

Scan another product

Matched by barcode

The best result. The barcode matches an NIH label record. Tap **Show ingredients & evidence** to open the label.

LIKELY MATCH

Sample Brand – Vitamin D3 2,000 IU Softgels

on market · entered NIH 2025-03-01

NIH lists a product with this name, possibly in a different package size. Compare the ingredient list with the bottle in your hand.

Show ingredients & evidence ›

Scan another product

Likely match

NIH lists a product with this name, possibly in a different package size. The ingredients are usually the same, but **compare the ingredient list with the bottle in your hand.**

Other close labels are listed under **Other close NIH labels**, and **Not the right one? Search NIH** opens a normal search.

BARCODE 0 12345 67890 5

We could not identify this barcode

None of the product databases we check knows this number. Try typing the product name in Search, or scan the bottle again.

Search by name

Scan another product

Take a photo of the barcode

Or type the barcode number

Look up

We could not identify this barcode

None of the product databases the app checks knows this number. Tap **Search by name**, type the product name, or scan the bottle again. Some small brands are simply not in any of these databases.

OFF-MARKET LABELS

NIH keeps records of products that are no longer sold. If your match is marked off market, the app says so, and the product may have been reformulated since. Compare the label with your bottle.

RECENTLY SCANNED

The Scan screen lists your last 20 scans so you can reopen a product without scanning again. **Clear** removes the list. It is kept only on your phone.

Finding a Supplement

No barcode, or it will not scan? Search instead. You can type, say it aloud, or tap a Quik Search tile. All three ask the NIH label database.

1 Type in the search box

Enter a product, a brand, or an ingredient, then tap **Go**. Adding the brand narrows things quickly: "Nature Made Vitamin D3" finds your product faster than "vitamin D" alone.

2 Or say it with the microphone

Tap the **microphone** inside the search box, allow it if asked, and say a product, brand, or ingredient. The search starts when you stop talking. If the microphone is missing or does not respond (some phones do not allow it in Home Screen mode), tap the box and use the microphone key on your keyboard.

3 Or tap a Quik Search tile

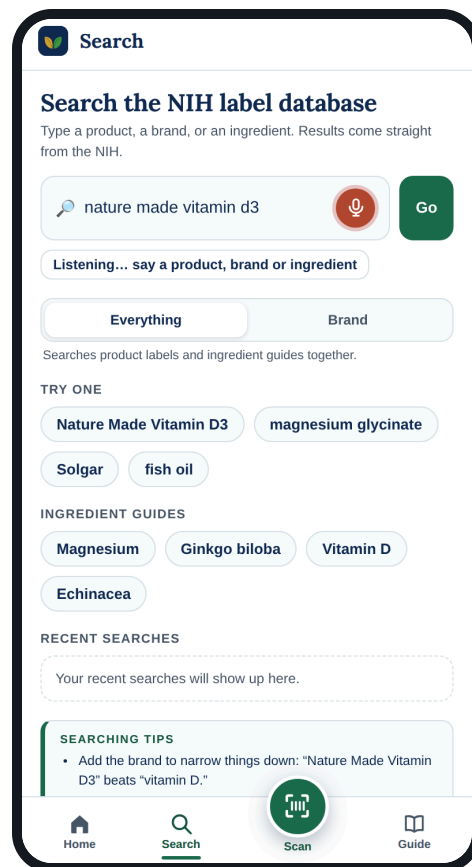
Common Ingredients lists 25 of the most common supplement ingredients, and **Major Brands** lists well-known producers. Swipe a row sideways, or tap **See All** for a grid.

4 Pick your product from the results

Tap the product that matches the bottle in your hand. For some ingredients, an ingredient guide (monograph) appears with the labels.

5 Use Back to go back

The arrow at the top left takes you one screen back. **Home** returns to the start, **Search** puts the cursor in the search box, and the round **Scan** button opens the camera.



Search by voice: the microphone is inside the search box.

TIP

Product not turning up? Try the brand name alone, or drop a word such as "Complex" or "Advanced." NIH label records use the exact wording printed on the bottle, which does not always match how a product is marketed. The tiles show how the NIH records a brand name, so a brand tile may list a sub-brand separately.

GOOD TO KNOW

Results come live from the NIH. If the NIH is busy or your signal is weak, you will see a message with a Try again button. Nothing is made up while you wait.

Reading the Label Screen

Open any product and you see its NIH label record, followed by the two evidence buttons. The illustration shows a sample product.

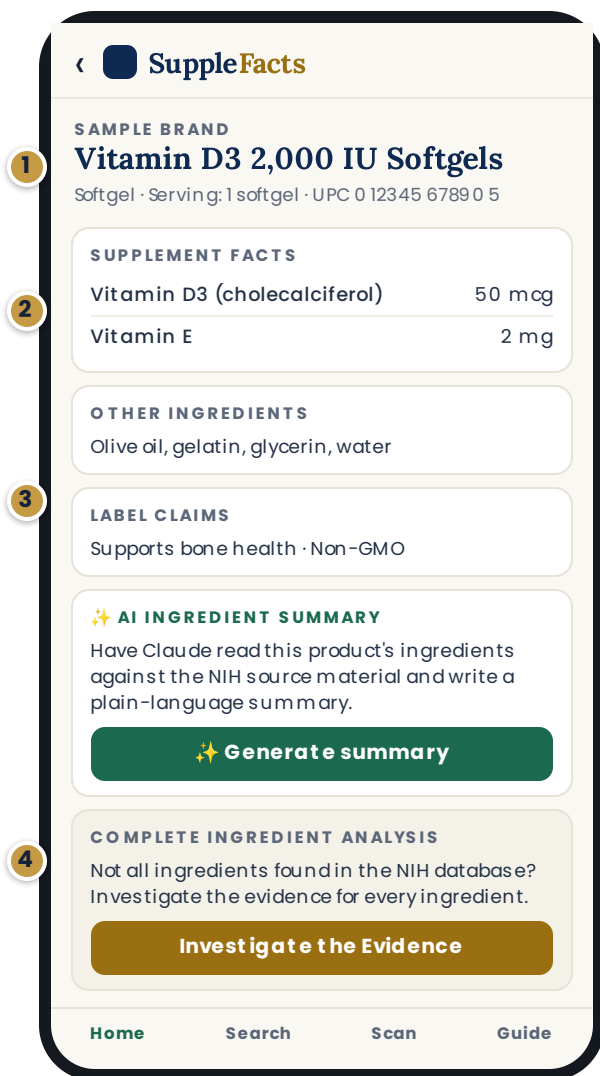


Illustration of a label screen. Your screen shows the real product.

- 1 Product details.** Brand, product name, form, serving size, and barcode (UPC), exactly as recorded in the NIH database. If NIH marks the label off market, a note here says so.
- 2 Supplement Facts.** Each declared ingredient with its amount per serving and % Daily Value where the label lists one. Tap a row that says **View ingredient monograph** to read its guide. A row that says **Ask AI** has no guide in the app; tap it to investigate that one ingredient (see Part Three).
- 3 Other ingredients and label claims.** Fillers, binders, and capsule materials, plus the wording the manufacturer uses on the label. Claims appear as chips; they are the maker's statements, not findings.
- 4 The two evidence buttons.** **Generate summary** (green) gives you a quick read inside the app. **Investigate the Evidence** (gold) sends the full label to a research assistant of your choice. The next two pages cover each one.

LOOK FOR

- **Proprietary blends:** a total weight with no per-ingredient amounts. You cannot tell how much of each ingredient you are getting.
- **Missing % Daily Value:** some ingredients have no official daily target, so none is listed.
- **Dose units:** mcg, mg, IU. Many labels also put the amount "per serving" while the bottle's directions say to take more than one.

The line under the label reads: "Shows what the manufacturer declares — not contaminant testing." A label tells you what a maker says is in the bottle. It does not tell you whether the product was tested.

AI Ingredient Summary

The green **Generate summary** button gives you a fast, plain-language read on the product you are looking at. It is the quickest of the two evidence buttons and it stays inside the app.

1 Open a product, then scroll to the AI Ingredient Summary panel

It sits just under the label, above the gold Investigate button.

2 Tap "Generate summary"

The panel shows "Asking Claude..." and then "Writing..." while the answer builds. It usually takes a few seconds, and the finished summary scrolls into view on its own. The app sends Claude only this product's label information (ingredients, amounts, serving, form, and claims), not anything about you.

3 Read the summary

You get plain paragraphs: what the main ingredients are, what the research says about them, anything worth watching for, and how the product's makeup compares with what the evidence supports. The panel notes that it was generated by Claude and is not medical advice.

4 Tap "Regenerate" for a fresh version

If you open the same product again later, the saved summary appears right away. Tap **Regenerate** if you want Claude to write a new one.

WHAT THE SUMMARY IS GOOD FOR

- A quick orientation before you decide whether a product deserves a closer look.
- Translating a long ingredient list into everyday language.
- Spotting ingredients you want to ask your pharmacist or doctor about.

WHAT IT IS NOT

- It is a starting point written by AI, not a verdict. Treat every claim as something to verify.
- It reads only what is on this label. It does not know your medicines, your health conditions, or the product's lab testing.
- For a full dose-by-dose comparison with published studies, use the second button (next page).

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

"Claude is busy right now" means too many requests arrived at once; wait a moment and tap **Try again**. If a message says the live summary is not switched on, the app offers a **Full analysis on the website** button that opens the second option instead.

Investigate the Evidence

The gold **Investigate the Evidence** button goes beyond the label. It builds a research prompt from this exact product, then hands it to the AI assistant you choose: Claude, ChatGPT, or Perplexity.

1 Tap "Investigate the Evidence"

It is the gold button at the bottom of the product screen, under "Complete ingredient analysis." The app opens the Product Lookup page of The American Supplement Investigation in a new tab, with your whole label already loaded in a research prompt.

2 Look over the prompt (optional)

The prompt appears in a box so you can see what will be sent. It asks the AI to explain each ingredient, summarize the evidence, flag safety concerns and interactions, and note where evidence is weak or missing.

3 Choose where to run it

Tap **Analyze with Claude**, **Analyze with ChatGPT**, or **Analyze with Perplexity** to open that assistant with your prompt, or tap **Copy Full Research Prompt** to paste it into any AI you like, including Gemini.

4 Read the answer, then check its sources

A good answer compares the dose with what studies used and names safety issues. Treat every citation as a starting point and confirm it says what the AI claims.

Just one ingredient? Tap "Ask AI" on its row

A row marked **Ask AI** has no guide in the app. Tap it for a screen with that ingredient's own **Investigate the Evidence** button, then tap **Back to the original label** to return to the same spot.

Optional: add a photo of the label

The screen has a box that says **Paste label image URL (optional)**. If you paste the web address of a photo of the label, the button opens the lookup page with that image instead of the standard prompt. Leave it blank for the normal prompt.

Which button should I use?

	GENERATE SUMMARY	INVESTIGATE THE EVIDENCE
Speed	Seconds, stays in the app	Opens another page and an AI app
Best for	A first look at one product	Checking doses, comparing studies, asking follow-up questions
Who writes it	Claude, through SuppleFacts	The assistant you pick, on your account
Account	None needed	Your own account with the AI app you choose

SuppleFacts does not see your chat with Claude, ChatGPT, or Perplexity. Once the prompt is sent, you are using that company's app under your own account and privacy terms.

Setting Up Claude, ChatGPT & Perplexity

All three assistants work in your phone's web browser and also have their own apps. Each requires an account, and plans and usage limits change over time. Sign in once, ahead of time, so the evidence check runs smoothly the first time.

Claude

by Anthropic

1. Search **Claude** in the App Store or Google Play and install the app from **Anthropic** (or just use claude.ai in your browser).
2. Open it and sign in or create an account with your email or your Google or Apple account.
3. In SuppleFacts, tap **Analyze with Claude**. The full prompt is copied to your clipboard and Claude opens a **blank chat**.
4. Tap the message box, **press and hold** until the menu appears, tap **Paste**, then tap the send arrow.

ChatGPT

by OpenAI

1. Search **ChatGPT** in the App Store or Google Play and install the app from **OpenAI** (or use chatgpt.com in your browser).
2. Sign in or create an account.
3. In SuppleFacts, tap **Analyze with ChatGPT**. ChatGPT opens with your prompt already in the message box.
4. Tap the send arrow. If the box is empty (this can happen with a very long label), the full prompt is on your clipboard: press and hold in the box, tap **Paste**, then send.

Perplexity

by Perplexity AI

1. Search **Perplexity** in the App Store or Google Play and install it (or use perplexity.ai in your browser).
2. Sign in or create an account. Some answers work without one, but signing in lets you keep your searches.
3. In SuppleFacts, tap **Analyze with Perplexity**. Perplexity opens and **runs the search automatically**, with sources listed beside the answer.
4. If it opens without your prompt, the full prompt is on your clipboard. Press and hold in the search box, tap **Paste**, and send.

GOOD TO KNOW

- **Browser or app?** Depending on your phone, the link opens in your browser or straight in the app. Both work, with the same steps.
- **Sign in first.** If you are not signed in when the page opens, sign in, tap Back, and run the analysis again.
- **Why Claude needs a paste.** Claude does not accept a ready-made prompt from a link, so SuppleFacts copies it and you paste it. ChatGPT and Perplexity can receive it directly.

App names, screens, and plan limits change. If a label on your phone looks different, look for the same idea: a new chat, a message box, and a send arrow.

Questions to Ask Next

The research prompt starts the conversation. The real value comes from follow-up questions. Because the AI already has the exact product, ingredients, and doses, you can check doses and compare studies in the same chat. Copy any of these in.

Check the doses

"For each ingredient in this product, compare the amount per serving with the doses used in published clinical trials. Where is this product's dose lower or higher than what the studies tested?"

"Is any ingredient at or above the tolerable upper intake level for adults? Give the source for that limit."

Compare the studies

"Which ingredients here have strong evidence, which have moderate or limited evidence, and which have none? Rate each Strong / Moderate / Limited / No Benefit / Harm."

"Summarize the most recent systematic reviews and randomized trials on *[ingredient]* for *[reason you take it]*. What did they actually find?"

"Does the evidence differ for people who are not deficient in this nutrient?"

Check the sources

"List every study or source you used with title, journal, year, and a link, so I can check them myself."

"What would change your answer? What evidence is still missing?"

Bring your own situation

"Does this product interact with *[medicine you take]*?"

BEFORE YOU SHARE PERSONAL DETAILS

Naming your medicines makes the answer more useful, but it also puts that information into an AI company's system. Share only what you are comfortable sharing, and never your name, address, or account numbers.

ALWAYS VERIFY

AI assistants can misquote studies or invent citations that look real. Open the sources they list, and confirm anything about safety or interactions with your pharmacist or doctor.

What the Label Can, and Can't, Tell You

SuppleFacts is not a database this site built or maintains. Every search runs live against the NIH Office of Dietary Supplements' Dietary Supplement Label Database (DSLD), a public, government-run record of what manufacturers have submitted. Keeping it that way is deliberate: the NIH stays the source of truth for what is on the label, and the app's job is connecting that label to the evidence.

IMPORTANT LIMITATIONS

Label data is manufacturer-reported. A label in the database may be incomplete or out of date, and a product's presence is not an endorsement by the NIH, FDA, or HHS. It is a record of what a label says.

A scan is a lookup, not an inspection. A barcode identifies a product, and the app then finds the NIH label for it. A barcode can be shared by several package sizes, and a label may have changed since your bottle was made, so always compare the ingredient list with the bottle in your hand.

The label is not a lab test. It lists what the maker declares. It does not show whether the bottle contains what it says, or whether it is free of contaminants.

The AI is a research assistant, not an authority. Treat its analysis as a well-organized starting point. Verify anything important against the cited sources and with a pharmacist or physician.

SuppleFacts does not replace medical advice. It is built to help you ask better questions of your doctor or pharmacist, not to substitute for that conversation.

Quick tips

- Brand tiles use the brand name as the NIH records it, so a company's separate sub-brands appear on their own.
- Labels change. A product you check today may be reformulated later, so search again before you re-buy.
- For a ranked look at America's best-selling supplements against the clinical evidence, see the Top 25 Supplements guide on the website. SuppleFacts shows you the label; the Top 25 guide adds the site's own evidence ratings for the most commonly searched ingredients.
- Printable help for your next appointment: the "What Are You Taking?" medication-and-supplement worksheet at the end of Book Two, *The Hollow Aisle*.

Data source: National Institutes of Health, Office of Dietary Supplements, Dietary Supplement Label Database (dslid.od.nih.gov). Public domain, CC0 1.0. Statements on supplement labels have not been evaluated by the FDA. Supplements are not intended to diagnose, treat, cure, or prevent any disease.

Every Feature, One Page

Keep this page handy.

FEATURE	WHAT IT IS FOR	WHERE TO FIND IT
Scan	Read a bottle's barcode and find its NIH label	Round green button, bottom bar
Photo or typed barcode	Backups when the live scan will not read	Scan screen, below the camera
Recently scanned	Your last 20 scans, to reopen without scanning	Scan screen, Clear to remove
Search box	Search the NIH label database by product, brand, or ingredient	Home tab, top
Microphone	Say a product, brand, or ingredient instead of typing	Inside the search box
Quik Search	One-tap searches: 25 common ingredients and major brands	Home tab, swipe or See All
Label screen	Brand, product, form, serving, ingredients and amounts, claims	Tap any product
Ingredient guides	Plain-language and clinical-detail monographs	Tap an ingredient card
Generate summary	A quick plain-language read on one product, by Claude	Label screen, green button
Investigate the Evidence	Full label and research prompt sent to Claude, ChatGPT, or Perplexity	Label screen, gold button
Guide tab	This guide	Bottom bar, right
FAQ and Evidence Library	Sourced answers and every citation	/faq, /annotated-bibliography

If something doesn't work

- **No results:** shorten the search, try the brand alone, or check spelling.
- **Camera will not start:** allow the camera for Safari (or the app) in your phone's Settings, then try again.
- **Barcode not identified:** type the digits under the bars, or search by name.
- **Microphone does nothing:** use the microphone key on your keyboard.
- **"Couldn't reach the NIH":** tap Try again in a moment.
- **Summary won't generate:** wait and tap Try again, or use Investigate the Evidence.
- **Prompt missing in the AI app:** it is on your clipboard. Press and hold in the message box and tap Paste.
- **App looks out of date:** close and reopen it, or re-add the Home Screen icon.



Before You Take That Supplement, Check the Evidence.

For patients, clinicians, and the public. Independent, with no industry
sponsorship or advertising.

supplements.brokenpromiseshealthcare.org/supplefacts.html

Questions or corrections: outreach@brokenpromiseshealthcare.org

INDEPENDENT · EVIDENCE-BASED